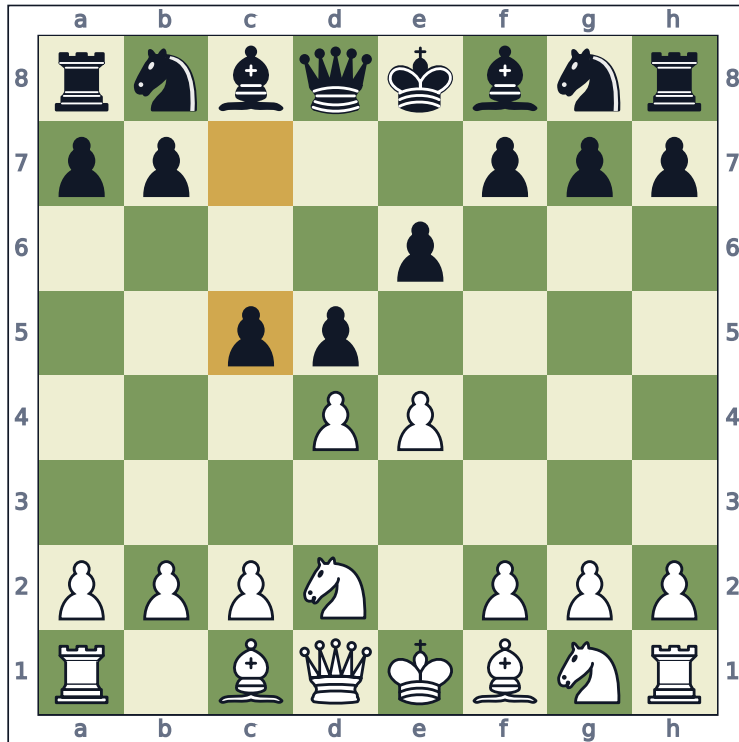


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C07 | 7 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.34 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C07 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C07 line

This section preserves all 7 names and defining routes assigned to C07 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Chistyakov Defense

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 Qxd5

002 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Chistyakov Defense, Modern Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Ngf3 cxd4 6. Bc4 Qd6 7. O-O Nf6 8. Nb3 Nc6 9. Nbx d4 Nxd4 10. Nxd4 a6

003 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Eliskases Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Ngf3 cxd4 6. Bc4 Qd8

004 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5

005 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System, Euwe-Keres Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. Ngf3

006 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System, Shaposhnikov Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 Nf6

007 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System, Süchting Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. c3